

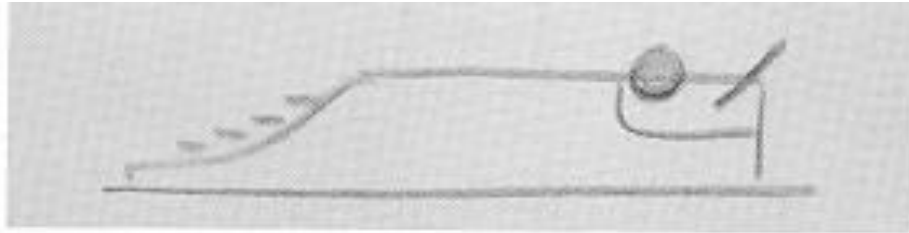


« In the Lettera 22 Portable Typewriter, which is light in weight and compact in shape for ease of transportation and storage, the designer has preserved more clearly the appearance of a box. This appearance is enhanced by a subtle integration of parts. Here the uniform putty-beige color is punctuated by a most effective accent - one single tabulator key of brightest red. The keys themselves are modeled like shallow bowls, a shape inviting both to the eye and to the finger. » (*Olivetti: Design in Industry*, Museum of Modern Art Bulletin, New York, 1952)

« All levers, of which the handle is a very common example, are fairly simple cases, where the form may grow out of a special study of the direct action of the hand, and where the choice of ways in which the hand can grasp them and the details of body and outline leave considerable freedom to the imagination. » (Nizzoli)

The Lettera 22 was awarded the Compasso d'Oro in 1954.



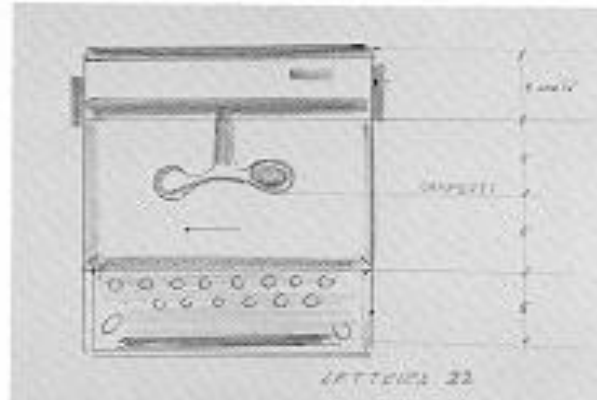
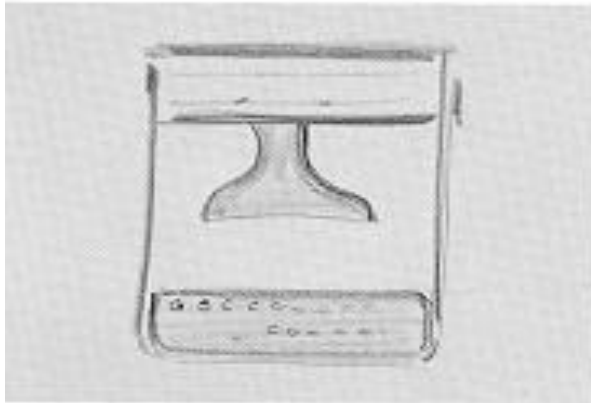


1., 2. and 6. Three views of the Lettera 22.

(Photographs by Aldo Ballo)

3., 4. and 5. Studies by Nizzoli for the Lettera 22.

7. The carrying case of the Lettera 22.



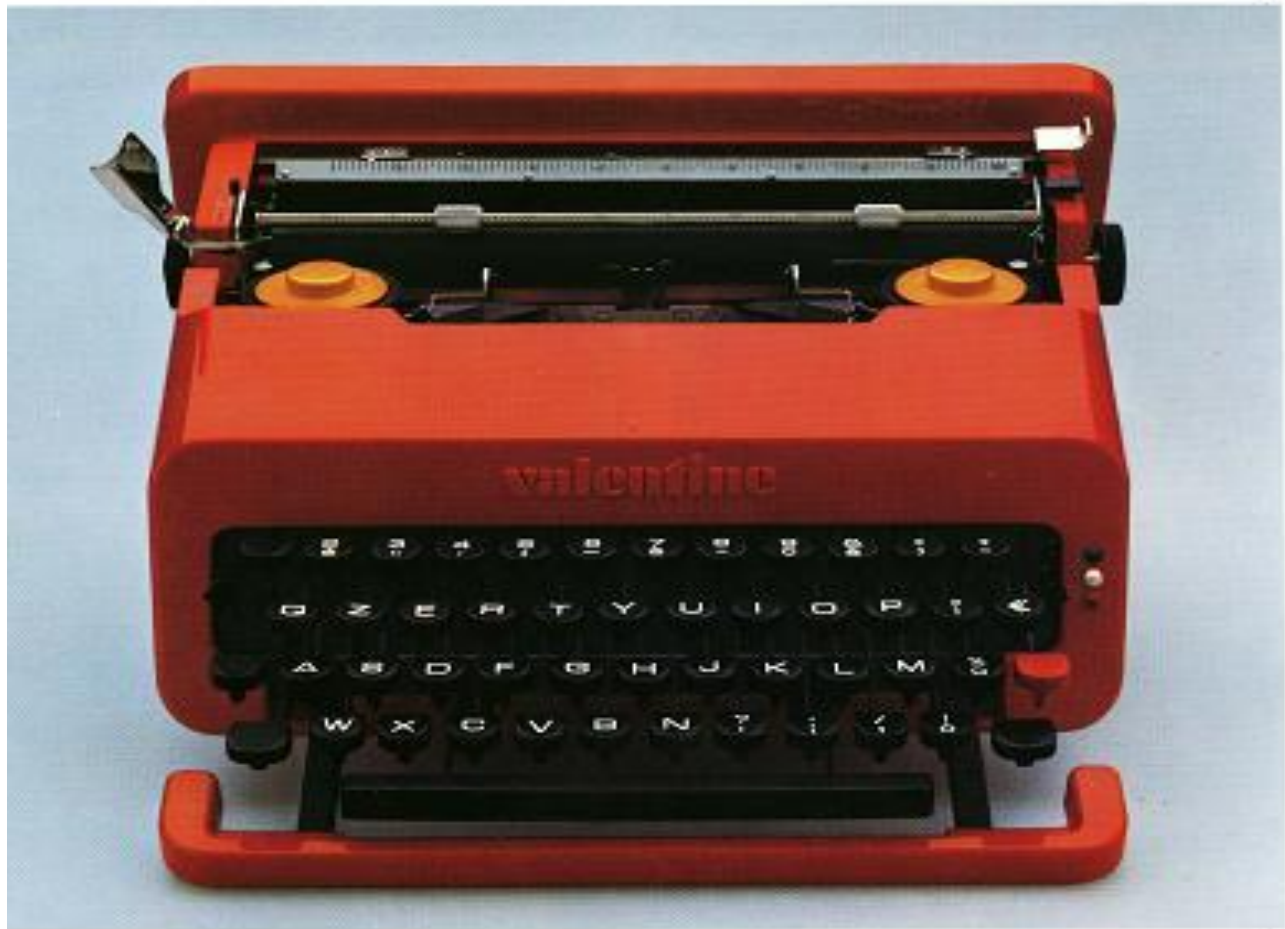
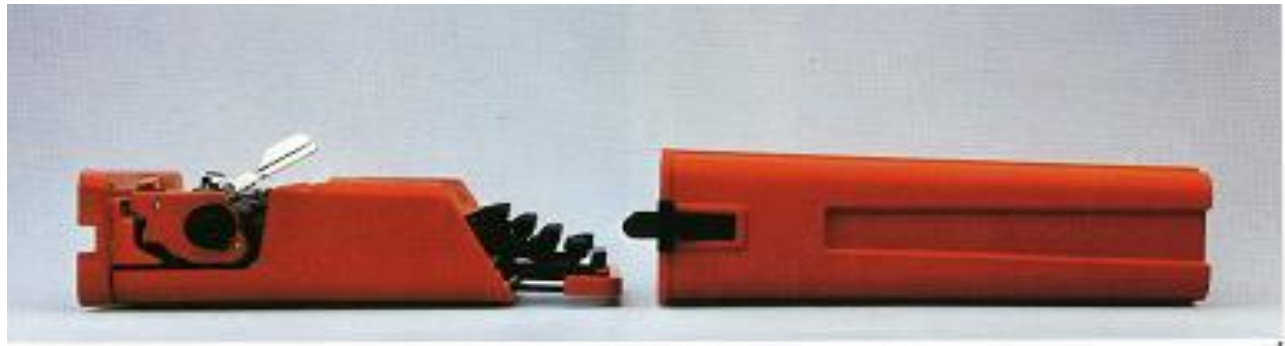
An example of the Lettera 22 is exhibited in the permanent design collection at the Museum of Modern Art in New York



« It is called Valentine and was invented for use any place except in an office, so as not to remind anyone of monotonous working hours, but rather to keep amateur poets company on quiet Sundays in the country or to provide a highly colored object on a table in a studio apartment. An anti-machine machine, built around the commonest mass-produced mechanism, the works inside any typewriter, that may also seem to be an unpretentious toy. 'Seem' — but here one is aware of all the commitment of open-minded but rigorous design, which starts from a secure knowledge of good technology and in utilizing it succeeds in transforming a useful object into a means of expression. The two elements of the machine itself, that is all one with the handle and cover, and its container with the two black rubber hooks, are made of orange-red injection molded ABS. Yellow, and also in ABS, are the two buttons of the ribbon spools, like the two eyes of a robot.

The machine's works are visible. The only shield against dust is provided by the front shell from which the keys project and the red rim enclosing them. » (*Abitare*, n. 77, op cit.)

Following in the tradition of the outstanding and universally admired Lettera 22, this Valentine is not just a more 'modern' version of the Lettera 22 with revised details and alterations suggested by the state of progress of competitor products. On the contrary, it is an entirely new typewriter which differs from its forerunner both in form and approach. It has a new, dashing and unconventional air compared





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- 1.-5. Various views of the Valentine typewriter.
 6. Detail of the carrying case.
 7. Detail of the keyboard.
 an (1., 2. and 5. Photographs by Ezio Frea;
 3. . Photograph by Roberto Zabban;
 4. and 6. Photographs by Alberto Fioravanti)

with the traditional Olivetti line. It would indeed suggest an equally unorthodox advertising approach. Finally, it is rather un-Italian, and these merits and requisites make it a worthy heir to the Lettera 22.

Concerning the standards that inspired its design, it is worth reading what Ettore Sottsass has to say on the subject: "... an object that one takes along with one as one takes one's jacket, shoes and hat... We designed the Valentine... in the belief that a biro, a hat, a jacket or a portable can also belong to a particular type of rhythm, to a catalogue of values and to the measurement of spaces or environments which are not inevitably those of property, continuity, definition and all these things, but can also be the environments, spaces, rhythms, dimensions and values of a continuous creativity, of the permanent discarding and recreation of languages..." The machine is as we see it. A 'red object' segmented, discontinuous, fragmentary, and not even exempt from a few intentional discrepancies of form. An object that can be placed anywhere, appealing and highly visible, momentary and at the same time not different from the numerous other things which make up the panorama of our daily lives. From the structural point of view emphasis is placed particularly on the relation between the machine and its holder, achieved through a partial integration of the two units. » (*Premio Compasso d'Oro ADI 1970*, op. cit., p. 20)

An example of the Valentine is exhibited in the permanent design collection at the Museum of Modern Art in New York.





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1. - 9. Advertisements and posters for the Valentine by Ettore Sottsass jr. and Roberto Pieraccini. Copywriter by Giovanni Giudici and Luigi Fruttero.
10. Basrelief for the Valentine by Ettore Sottsass jr.



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HISTORY OF THE COMPANY

- 1908 by Camillo Olivetti, the principal investor, with an initial capital stock of 350,000 lire. Other, stockholders include friends and relatives who put in modest sums, used to buy the first Browne and Sharpe automatic lathes and the first milling machines. The plant covers an area of 500 square meters, and employs a staff of 20. At the end of November, when Olivetti leaves for the United States to acquire know-how and equipment, work begins on his design of a type bar mechanism.
- 1911 The Olivetti MI, the first typewriter constructed in Italy, is shown at the Turin Universal Exhibition.
- 1920 The new M 20 typewriter is brought out in Italy.
- 1922 Olivetti produces some 2,000 machines during the year.
- 1924 Adriano Olivetti, Camillo's eldest son, starts work in the factory. A machine tool production shop opens. Employees number 400 by the end of the year, and production has reached 4,000 machines.
- 1925 Adriano Olivetti leaves for a study tour of the United States.
- 1926 Adriano Olivetti returns from the U.S.A. and joins his father in the management of the firm. A company reorganization begins.
- 1928 An advertising office is created, under the direction of Adriano Olivetti.
- 1929 The reorganization has positive results: 13,000 machines are turned out and the company is in a solid position to face the world depression. The plans and projects office is formed, and work begins on the development of the M 40 typewriter.
- 1931 The advertising and development office is launched, under the direction of Renato Zveteremich. Those associated with the office include the painter Xanty Schawinsky, the designers Persico and Nizzoli, the graphic artists Munari and Veronesi, the printer Modiano, the Studio Boggeri, the architects Figini, Pollini, Banfi, Belgiojoso, Peressutti and Rogers. Development of the MP 1 portable typewriter begins. The body design is by Aldo Magnelli.
- 1932 Adriano Olivetti opens an office in Milan for marketing new products.
- 1933 Adriano Olivetti is named general manager. The 25th anniversary of the company is celebrated, while the reorganization begun in 1926 is extended throughout the firm. The year's production amounts to 15,000 office typewriters and 9,000 portables. Company personnel numbers 870; market outlets exist in Egypt, Tunis, Argentina, Brazil, Bolivia, Chile, Ecuador, Syria, Albania, Austria, Belgium, Czechoslovakia, Denmark, France, Yugoslavia, Norway, Holland, Spain, Sweden, Turkey and Hungary.
- 1934 Company employees number 1,000.
- 1935 The Studio 42 semistandard typewriter is designed by Ottavio Luzzati, with Schawinsky, Figini and Pollini, and Olivetti technical staff.
- 1936 Extensions to the factory buildings are drawn up by Figini and Pollini. Massimo Olivetti and Giuseppe Beccio begin work on a teleprinter project. Adriano Olivetti launches a project for a regional plan for the Aosta Valley, the first attempt at territorial planning in Italy. Collaborators on the project include Banfi, Belgiojoso, Peressutti, Rogers, Bottoni, Figini, Pollini, Lauro and Zveteremich.
- 1937 A new factory wing is completed, enabling production to be increased to 21,575 office typewriters and 15,694 portables. Exports of these models reach 9,502 units. Company employees number over 2,000. A housing estate for Olivetti workers is commissioned from Figini and Pollini.
- 1938 Construction of the new plant designed by Bottoni and Pucci begins in Massa Apuana. Camillo Olivetti resigns as chairman, but continues to take an active interest in the company's activities and development. He is replaced as chairman by Adriano Olivetti.
- 1939 Production in Italy amounts to 23,413 office type writers, 19,288 semi-standards and portables, and 333 teleprinters.
- Company employees number 2,300. Capital stock is increased to 23 million lire.
- The Summa MC 4S is introduced, the first adding machine entirely designed and produced by Olivetti. The use of die-casting techniques permits the introduction of innovative design solutions.
- A new factory, designed by Italo Lauro, is opened by Hispano Olivetti in Barcelona.
- With the end of the war, the company again becomes active on foreign markets. A first shipment of 600 machines is sent to Buenos Aires, via New York. During the year, Olivetti Argentina sells 3,269 office machines, 492 portables, and 272 calculators through its extensive commercial network. Exports begin to Uruguay, and a first sales base is established in New York. The Elettrosomma 14 electric printing adding machine, designed by Natale Capellaro, is presented, the first model in the series which establishes Olivetti's international reputation in the calculator field. The advertising office is reorganized in Milan, under the direction of the graphic artist Giovanni Pintori.
- The Lexikon 80 typewriter and the Divisumma calculator go into production, from technical projects by Giuseppe Beccio and Natale Capellaro respectively, and body designs by Nizzoli. Innovations in their fields, the two machines open up a vast market for Olivetti. Production begins on the T 2 teleprinter.
- The Ivrea factory is enlarged to the west by Figini, Pollini and Fiocchi. The Lettera 22 portable typewriter is introduced, giving fresh impetus to a traditional Olivetti production sector, while the new Lexikon Elettrica provides greater efficiency in an office model. Designed by Nizzoli, the technical features of these models are by Beccio. The Olivetti Corporation of America is formed in New York, headed by Dino Olivetti, Camillo's third son.
- Construction begins on the new R & D center in Ivrea, designed by Eduardo Vittoria. An Olivetti

- exhibition is held at the Museum of Modern Art in New York, the first time a European industrial company is invited by the Museum to display its products and graphics work.
- 1953 In England, the Watford Technical College holds an exhibition of Olivetti industrial design and products.
- 1954 An Olivetti showroom opens on Fifth Avenue in New York, designed by Belgiojoso, Peressutti and Rogers. Interior mural by Costantino Nivola.
- 1955 The Audit 202 accounting machine is introduced. The Pozzuoli factory and housing estate, designed by Cosenza, are opened. The Olivetti sales headquarters in Via Clerici, Milan, are inaugurated. Architects: Fiocchi, Bernasconi and Nizzoli; decor: Nizzoli, Pintori and Moreni. The Canavese Institute for Town and Country Development (IRUR) is formed to promote new agricultural and industrial initiatives, and to relieve unemployment. The company takes part in the International Exhibition of Advertising and Graphic Art at the Louvre, Paris. Olivetti products form the nucleus of an exhibition of Italian industrial design at the Italian Cultural Institute in London. Construction work begins on the new factory in Ivrea, designed by Figini and Pollini.
- 1956 Three new products are introduced: the Tetractys superautomatic calculator with two registers; the Divisumma 24 calculator; the Audit 302 alphanumeric accounting machine.
- 1957 Work begins on the new plant in São Paulo, Brazil, designed by Marco Zanuso. Introduction of the Graphika proportional spacing typewriter and of the Elettrosumma 22 calculator. A photoelectric pantograph, developed in the Olivetti machine tool plant, and the Tetractys calculator are shown at the Fair at the New York Coliseum.
- 1959 The Lettera 22 is selected by a jury of the world's 100 best-known designers as the best industrial product of the last 100 years, in a competition sponsored by the Illinois Institute of Technology. The Olivetti Corporation of America moves to 1 Park Avenue. The first Italian electronic computer, Olivetti Elea 9003, goes into production at the Borgolombardo laboratory. Tape punch accounting machines, for connection with computing centres go into production in Ivrea. An agreement is reached in New York for close production cooperation with the Underwood company, in which Olivetti acquires a 30% equity investment. In November, the Elea 9003 is resented in Milan. The new staff canteen opens in Ivrea, designed by Ignazio Gardella. Inauguration of the factory in São Paulo, Brazil.
- 1960 Adriano Olivetti dies on February 27, in Aigle, Switzerland. The University of Florence confers a posthumous degree in political science. Introduction of the Mercator 5000 electronic accounting billing machine, based on mechanical research at the Ivrea R&D center and electronic research at the Borgolombardo laboratory. The new 6001 computer for scientific applications is completed at Borgolombardo.
- 1961 The first Scarmagno plant goes into operation. Designed by Ottavio Cascio, it covers an area of 55,000 square meters, and includes an infirmary, canteen (serving 1,200), bar, lounge and library. Scarmagno employees number 800. The Recensor 2000 electronic center with tape punch for accounting analyses, and the RP 50 and RP 60 production data recorders and attendance timeclocks are introduced. A mountain holiday camp for employees' children designed by Conte and Fiori opens at Brusson, in the Aosta Valley. An exhibition of Olivetti products is shown at the Moscow Polytechnic Museum, on the invitation of the Soviet Ministry of Trade. The San Bernardo d'Ivrea plant completes a 33-station NC transfer machine for gear boxes for the ZKL tractor factory in Brno, Czechoslovakia.
- 1962 The Adriano Olivetti Foundation is formed, for the promotion, development and coordination of "those initiatives which, in keeping with the principles affirmed and pursued by Adriano Olivetti in his thought and achievements, contribute to the well-being, instruction, education and social progress of the community". Natale Capellaro receives an honorary degree in engineering from the University of Bari for his work as chief designer of Olivetti calculators. Electronic production begins at the Caluso factory, near Turin. Besides the 9003 and 6001 computers, the plant manufactures CBS and CBN converters, and electronic processing units for traditional electromechanical machines.
- 1963 The CMC 7 electronic magnetic character encoders are introduced. The Pregnana laboratory near Milan completes the new Elea 4001 computer.
- 1964 In August an agreement is concluded with the General Electric Company of New York for the formation of a joint venture, Olivetti-General Electric, which replaces the Olivetti Electronics Division. General Electric and Olivetti hold 75% and 25% respectively of equity.
- 1965 The new electronic desk-top computer, Programma 101, is presented at the B.E.M.A. in New York. In Moscow, an agreement is signed for cooperation and technical assistance between Olivetti and various Soviet agencies. Introduction of the Elea 4-115 computer, fully designed and produced in Italy, for worldwide distribution. Production begins on the Praxis 48 electric typewriter, the Simplex adding machine, the Multisumma 20 calculator, the Logos 27 mechanical super-calculator, the Tekne 4 typewriter with polythene ribbon, the Editor proportional spacing electric typewriter. The Dora and the Lettera DL portable typewriters, based on the Lettera 32, go into production at the Agliè plant, near Turin. An associated company of Olivetti Underwood begins production of the Copia II copier, while the Copia 105 goes into production in Italy.
- 1966 The new headquarters of the Olivetti Corporation of Japan, designed by Cascio, are inaugurated in Tokyo. New machines include the Linea 88 manual standard typewriter, the Elettrosumma 23 electric calculator, the Logos 27-2 mechanical supercalculator with two registers. The San Bernardo d'Ivrea plant sets up an experimental research section, the Officina Alfa, and begins production of the NC machining centers Auctor Multiplex with 12 automatic coded tool positions, and Auctor Simplex, the measuring machines Inspector and Camspector, and the RQ position readout equipment. The Burolo Institute of Technology is set up for industrial research and production training.
- 1967 A new Olivetti showroom, designed by Gae Aulenti, opens in Faubourg St. Honoré, Paris. In October, the millionth Divisumma 24 comes off the assembly line at Ivrea. Olivetti introduces the first in a new product line of computer terminals. The company is chosen as the subject of a research seminar at Harvard University. The Horizon 3 and Horizon 1 NC machining centers are presented at the Hanover Fair.

- 1968 Olivetti's investment in Olivetti-General Electric is acquired by General Electric. The exhibition "The Great Age of Fresco - Giotto to Pontormo" sponsored by the Italian Government with the cooperation of Olivetti, opens at the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York, and is subsequently shown at the Rijksmuseum in Amsterdam, the Hayward Gallery in London, the National museum in Stockholm, the Lyngby Park Kapel in Copenhagen, and the Palazzo Reale in Milan. Olivetti Underwood's personnel training center in Tarrytown, New York, is opened.
- 1969 *Kyoto*, an art film directed by Ken Ichikawa for Olivetti, is shown at the Nissei Theater in Tokyo. An exhibition of major works of 20th-century art from the Gianni Mattioli collection is organized at the new Olivetti building at 500 Park Avenue, New York. The new Scarmagno plants, designed by Vittoria and Zanuso, and the Harrisburg plant, Pennsylvania, designed by Louis Kahn, are inaugurated. The Olivetti exhibition "Concepts and Form" is shown at the Musée des Arts Décoratifs in the Louvre, Paris, and subsequently in Barcelona, Madrid, Edinburgh, London and Tokyo.
- 1970 The new plant in Marcianise (Caserta), designed by Vittoria and Zanuso, begins operations, with the production of the Audit and Mercator accounting machines, and production reading and recording equipment. Extensions to the Pozzuoli plants are completed. Olivetti now has 11 plants in Italy: 3 in Ivrea, 2 at Scarmagno, 1 each in Agliè, Turin, Massa, Crema, Pozzuoli, Marcianise; and 10 plants abroad: 7 production plants, in Barcelona, Buenos Aires, Glasgow, Harrisburg, Toronto, São Paulo and Mexico City, and 3 assembly plants, in Bogotá, Johannesburg and Santiago. The Logos 270 and Logos 250 electronic calculators are presented on the market. In cooperation with Olivetti, the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York puts on the "Before Cortés" exhibition of pre-Columbian art, including 300 sculptures from Central America.
- 1971 The Valentine portable typewriter enters the permanent collection of the Museum of Modern Art in New York, which already includes the Lexikon 80 and the Lettera 22 typewriters, and the P 203 microcomputer. Construction work is completed on the new western residential unit in Ivrea, designed by Roberto Gabetti and Aimaro Isola. Olivetti sponsors the "Save Our Planet" ecological campaign, whose posters are designed by Edward Steichen, Richard Buckminster Fuller, Georgia O'Keefe, Ernest Trova, Roy Lichtenstein and Alexander Calder. Proceeds from the sale of these posters go to the Battelle Institute for Ecological Studies.
- 1972 The new headquarters of Deutsche Olivetti, designed by Egon Eiermann, are inaugurated in Frankfurt. The Synthesis Series 45 line of office furniture and fittings, designed by Ettore Sottsass jr., goes into production. Olivetti displays two stands at the Italian industry exhibition in Peking, when a first direct link is established between Italy and China through Olivetti teleprinters.
- 1973 The European Computer Manufacturers Association (E.C.M.A.) adopts a special dot matrix printing system for automatic readers, developed in cooperation with Olivetti. An agreement is signed with the Italian Metalworkers Union for the substitution of traditional assembly lines with integrated assembly units. This is the first such agreement in Italy. British Olivetti's new personnel training center in Haslemere is inaugurated. Plans for the new buildings are drawn up by James Stirling, the restoration and interiors of the existing buildings are directed by Edward Cullinan. Two new electronic calculators are introduced, the Divisumma 18 portable model, and the Divisumma 28 desk-top model. The first issue of *GO Informazioni*, a cultural, economic and technical periodical for circulation outside the company, is published.
- 1974 The American Institute of Architects awards Olivetti the Industrial Arts medal "for a history of excellence in communicating its image through product design, corporate communications, architecturally distinguished manufacturing and merchandising facilities, and sponsorship of numerous social, educational, recreational and cultural programs for both its employees and the general public". The new line of distributed data processing equipment, the A7, A5 and TC 800, is presented at the SICOB exhibition in Paris.
- 1975 The Sigma industrial robot, developed and constructed at the Scarmagno plants, is introduced at the international robot symposium in Chicago.
- 1976 Olivetti's exhibit at the Hanover Fair includes the P 6060 minicomputer for technical and scientific applications; the Logos 40 and Logos 42 calculators; new products in the distributed data processing line; golfball typewriters. Other new products introduced during the year include the TES 501 word processing system; software and hardware and an automatic teller for the TC 800; the A7/90; printers; the Logos 75 calculator for specialized applications; the Lexikon 90 office typewriter and Lexikon 82 portable electric typewriter, with golf ball printing elements and interchangeable ribbon cartridges; the Copia 400 copier; the Synthesis 80 line of office furniture and fittings. Olivetti Controllo Numerico produces the Contor control center for automatic lathes. Dino Olivetti, brother of Adriano, dies on December 24. He had been president and chairman of the Olivetti Corporation of America.
- 1977 The electronic calculator line is expanded with the Logos 40, 40 PD, 42, 42 PD with standard and display features, and the Logos 75 S and 75 B with pre-programming for administrative, commercial technical and scientific applications. Innovations shown at SICOB in Paris include the DE 700 line of data entry, conversion and transmission systems, and the P 6040 minicomputer. The TC480 interactive send-recv terminal is shown at the 24th International Review of Nuclear and Aerospace Electronics. This terminal, the TE 400 teleprinter and the CT 282 and CT 382 switching systems form a product range for complex communications networks. *Fortune* magazine selects the Lexikon 82 portable electric typewriter as one of the 25 best designed industrial products currently on the US market.
- 1978 Presentation of the TES 401 word processing system, with memory and line display. Olivetti's exhibit at the Hanover Fair includes the new calculators Divisumma 35 and 37 PD, Logos 80, Logos 3 and 7, the Lexikon 90 series of electric typewriters, the TCV 280 interactive video system, new peripherals for the TC 800. In April Carlo De Benedetti is appointed vice chairman and chief executive Officer. The stockholders vote to increase capital stock from 60 to 100 billion lire. In October Franco De Benedetti is appointed managing director. Annual report for 1977. Consolidated Group revenues in 1977 were 1,365.2 billion lire, an increase of 21.2% compared to 1976. Data processing equipment sales rose from 41.3% of total in 1976 to

42.5% in 1977. Breakdown of revenues: for the parent company - Italy 23.4%; - exports 3.6%; for the foreign subsidiaries - Europe 31.4%; - North America 14.2%; - Latin America 13.7%; - Asia and South Africa 9.4%; Italian subsidiaries 4.3%. Parent company revenues were 575.1 billion lire, an increase of 14.7% from 1976. Group employees at the end of 1977 were 66,073, a reduction of 2,924 compared to the end of 1976. The ET 101 electronic typewriter, a new development in the typewriter field, and the Copia 2000 plain paper modular copying system are presented at the SMAU exhibition in Milan.

1979 The stockholders vote to increase capital stock from 100 to up to 200 billion lire, through an issue of stock and Mediobanca Olivetti convertible bonds. The BCS 2000 and 3000 line of business computers is presented. Annual report for 1978. Consolidated Group revenues in 1978 were 1,555.8 billion lire, an increase of 14% compared to 1977. Sales of data processing equipment increased from 42.5% of total in 1977 to 43.5% in 1978. Breakdown of revenues: for the parent company - Italy 26.2%; - exports 2.9%; for the foreign subsidiaries - Europe 31.5%; - North America 11.6%; - Latin America 12.5%; - Asia and South Africa 10.1%; Italian subsidiaries 5.2%. Parent company revenues were 718.5 billion lire, an increase of 24.9% compared to 1977. Group employees were 61,534 at the end of 1978, a reduction of 4,539 compared to 1977. Seventy years of company activity in architecture, graphics and design are presented at the major US and Canadian universities. In the exhibition "Design Process Olivetti 1908-1978", organized in cooperation with the Department of Art of the University of California, Los Angeles. The ET 221 and ET 201 electronic typewriters, and the TC 800 ATS-TTW specialized bank terminal are introduced at the Hanover Fair. The TC 1800 is presented at SICOB in Paris, while the SMAU exhibit in Milan includes the new S 6000 business system, the ICS 6000 telephone network system and the CR electronic cash registers. Olivetti signs the largest contract in its history, to supply the Danish Savings Banks Consortium with six thousand terminal systems. The company is awarded the "Compasso d'Oro" for its design activities. An exhibition of the Horses of St. Mark's Basilica in Venice, designed and organized by Olivetti, opens at the Royal Academy in London, and is subsequently shown at the Metropolitan Museum in New York, the Museum of Modern Art in

Mexico City, the Grand Palais in Paris, the Martin Gropius Bau in Berlin.

1980 An agreement is signed with the Japanese company Hitachi and the US company IPL to market large and medium computers in Europe. Olivetti Peripheral Equipment reaches an agreement with the US Memorex Corporation for the development, production and distribution of disk memories. The Logos 9, the smallest printing pocket calculator on the world market, is presented at the Hanover Fair. Olivetti acquires one third of the capital of IPL Systems, the second-largest US producer of medium plug-compatible computers. Annual report for 1979. Consolidated Group revenues in 1979 were 1,852.7 billion lire, an increase of 19.1% compared to 1978. Data processing equipment sales rose from 49.9% of total in 1978 to 53.4% in 1979. Breakdown of revenues: Europe 67.3%, including 31.3% in Italy; North America 9.7%; Latin America 11.7%; Asia and South Africa 11.3%. Parent company revenues were 902.9 billion lire, an increase of 25.7% compared to 1978. Group employees were 55,931 at the end of 1979, a reduction of 5,603 compared to 1978. The stockholders vote to distribute a dividend of 100 lire to both common and preferred shares, after allocating 12.7 billion lire to reserves. The French company Saint Gobain Pont-à-Mousson enters the company controlling syndicate through acquisition of 21 million shares of common stock. An extraordinary general meeting votes to increase capital stock from 107.74 to 208.74 billion lire. An international bank syndicate led by the Union Bank of Switzerland and the Banca Commerciale Italiana grant Olivetti International S.A., an 8-year 100-million-dollar loan, at 5.8% on Libor. Industrial operations begin in Singapore for the assembly of printing electronic calculators. The TES 621 word processing system is presented on the Italian market. Olivetti acquires control of the Docutel Corporation of Dallas (Texas), a leading manufacturer of automatic teller machines, with the purchase of 304,500 Docutel shares, equivalent to 12% of equity. A technological and commercial cooperation agreement is concluded with the Northern Telecom Systems Corporation of Minneapolis (USA), in the plug-compatible terminal sector. A prototype laser printer adapted for use with the Copia 2000 copier, and an electronic mail service based on the S 6000 processing system are presented at SICOB in Paris. Adriano Olivetti is commemorated in Ivrea, on the

twentieth anniversary of his death, with a series of events organized by the Adriano Olivetti Foundation. A message from the President of the Republic, Sandro Pertini, recalls Olivetti as "an entrepreneurial and intellectual figure with few equals in our country". An agreement is signed with Syntrex Inc., a US producer of office automation equipment and a 25% equity investment is acquired in the company.

1981 A 3-year contract is signed with the EEC for the development of a computer programming system. A minority equity investment is acquired in Data Terminal Systems of Maynard (Massachusetts). The agreement provides for the acquisition of new DTS stock for an overall value of 10 million dollars and the purchase of the company's German subsidiary (DTS GmbH). A contract is obtained through the subsidiary in Johannesburg for the development and installation of an electronic bank savings system, to be distributed throughout South Africa. Olivetti acquires control of Hermes Precisa International S.A. (Yverdon, Switzerland). Hermes' commercial network remains separate from Olivetti's, except in Switzerland, where the two organizations will work in close cooperation to form the largest European supplier of office products and data processing equipment. Annual report for 1980. Consolidated Group revenues in 1980 were 2,180.2 billion lire, an increase of 17.7% compared to 1979. Data processing equipment sales rose from 53.4% in 1979 to 54.2% in 1980, while electronic typewriters and office products represented 8.3% and 37.5% respectively of sales. Breakdown of revenues: Europe 70.3%, including a 34.8% in Italy; North America 7.5%; Latin America 11.6%; Asia and South Africa 10.6%. Parent company revenues were 1,102.9 billion lire, an increase of 22.1% compared to 1979; company net income was 50.1 billion. The stockholders vote to distribute a dividend of 140 lire per share. Group employees were 53,339 at the end of 1980, a reduction of 2,592 compared to 1979. Olivetti signs a renewable 2-year contract in New York with the Union Bank of Switzerland and the Bank of America (guarantors), with the Morgan Guaranty (depositor) and with Lehman Brothers Kuhn Loeb, to issue commercial paper on the American financial market for a maximum value of 20 million dollars. The agreement is the first of its kind stipulated by an Italian company in the USA. At the invitation of the French government

Olivetti acquires management control of the French data processing company Logabax. Two Communications link-ups are demonstrated at SMAU in Milan with the cooperation of SIP (Italian state telephone company) and the Ministry of Posts and Telecommunications. The first link-up, for the Videotel service, is based on the new WS 588 terminal; the second is long-distance transmission and reception of typed texts between two ET 351 electronic typewriters for the Videotex service. The first portable electronic typewriters, Praxis 30 and Praxis 35 are also introduced. Olteco concludes an agreement with Northern Telecom Ltd. for the production in Italy of Northern Telecom's SL1 voice and data switching system, already distributed by Olivetti as the ICS 6000.

- 1982 The M 20 personal computer is presented to the world press in March. Introduction of the M 30 and M 40 models in the LI distributed data processing line, and the Praxis 40 and 45 compact electronic typewriters. Olivetti Sistemi per l'Automazione Industriale (OSAI) signs a commercial and technical cooperation agreement for industrial automation with the Westinghouse Electric Corporation. The five-year agreement provides for an initial purchase by Westinghouse of forty Sigma robots and an exclusive licence for the production, sale and service of these robots in North America. Olivetti and the Yugoslavian group Unis, of Sarajevo, sign a long-term industrial and commercial agreement for typewriter exchanges. Olteco reaches an agreement with Bolt Beranek and Newmann Inc., of Cambridge (Massachusetts), for the worldwide distribution of BBN's packet switching data networks. A cooperation agreement is concluded with the 3M company of St. Paul (Minnesota), for North American distribution by 3M of a line of electronic office typewriters produced by Olivetti in Italy. Olivetti acquires a 20% equity investment in Microoffice Systems Technology Inc. of Fairfield (Connecticut), a company specializing in advanced office automation systems and portable management work stations. Annual report for 1981. Consolidated Group revenues were 2,887.5 billion lire in 1981, an increase of 32.5% compared to 1980. Parent company revenues were 1,361.7 billion lire, an increase of 23.5% compared to 1980, while net income was 87.8 billion lire. The stockholders approve the distribution of dividends of 180 lire to common and preferred shares, 135 lire to common shares ranking for dividend as from April

1, 1981, and 100 lire to savings shares ranking for dividend as from July 1, 1981. An extraordinary general meeting approves the issue of a 5-year 120 billion lire non-convertible bond loan, ranking for interest as from May 1, 1982, at a six-monthly variable interest rate. A merger is announced between the Group's US subsidiary, Olivetti Corporation, and the Docutel Corporation, in which Olivetti already holds a 19.9% interest. Olivetti provides financial backing for the restoration of Leonardo da Vinci's "Last Supper". In June, Olivetti becomes the first large Italian company to publish its Group audited consolidated financial statements for the 1981 year. Consolidated net income, after taxes, was 95.6 billion lire. An agreement is reached with the Japanese company Sharp, for the exchange and joint development of office automation technologies and products. In September the stockholders approve a new capital stock increase (the fifth in four years), through an issue of 35,183,200 shares of non-convertible savings stock. A five-year special-rate 150-billion lire loan, granted by a syndicate of Italian and foreign banks, is also approved. This loan is linked to an additional issue by Olivetti of 66,750,000 shares of non-convertible savings stock, reserved for these banks. Olteco reaches a cooperation agreement with the British company Plessey Office System Ltd. for the distribution in Italy and some other European countries of a range of electronic telephone exchanges jointly developed by Plessey and British Telecom. Olteco will also produce this product line in Italy. Simone Fubini is appointed chief operating officer of the company, as from November 1, 1982. A joint venture is formed by OSAI and the US Allen-Bradley Corporation, a leading company in electro mechanics and NC machine tools. The new company, OSAI A-B, is owned 68% by Olivetti and 32% by Allen-Bradley. Olivetti enters the indirect distribution sector for data processing products in the USA through an agreement with MicroAge Computer Store of Phoenix (Arizona), in which it acquires a 49% equity investment. MicroAge controls a large chain of franchise stores specialized in the sale of personal and small business computers. An exhibition organized by Olivetti on the Cimabue Crucifix and the restoration of the damages caused by the 1966 floods in Florence, opens at the Louvre in Paris.

- 1983 Annual report for 1982. Consolidated Group revenues were 3,341.4 billion lire in 1982, an increase of 17.7% compared to 1981, while consolidated net profit was 102.8

billion lire (95.6 billion m 1981). Parent company revenues were 1,548.6 billion lire, an increase of 13.7% compared to 1981, while net profit was 94.1 billion lire (87.8 billion in 1981). The stockholders approve a dividend payment of 200 lire per common share and per preferred share, 220 lire per convertible savings share, 110 lire per non-convertible savings share with dividend accruing from July 1, 1982. Five hundred industrialists and managers from the public and private sectors, bank directors, university professors and economic experts, from Italy and other European countries, attend the "Giornata Olivetti Venture Capital", held at the Cini Foundation, Venice, in June. Chaired by Prof. Bruno Visentini and concluded by Carlo De Benedetti, the speakers at the Giornata include the major American venture capitalists. The Architecture and Design Committee of the Museum of Modern Art of New York puts two Olivetti machines into its permanent collection: the TCV 250 display terminal and the Logos 80 electronic calculator, both designed by Mario Bellini. Eleven Olivetti products are now included in the collection, forming the largest exhibit of high-quality industrial design by a single company in the museum. A report prepared by the London-based computer services company, Logica, and published by the American magazine Datamation, classifies Olivetti as the leading European computer manufacturer. Following his appointment as Minister of Finance, Prof. Bruno Visentini resigns as chairman and member of the board of the parent company. He is replaced as chairman by Carlo De Benedetti, who retains the post of chief executive officer. At SMAU in Milan, Olivetti presents the M 10 portable professional computer, whose features and high-performance capabilities place it at a level between hand-held computers and desk-top personal computers. A technical cooperation agreement is reached between Olivetti Peripheral Equipment and Philips Kommunikations Industrie; the two companies will jointly develop new products in the magnetic memory peripherals sector. The Cimabue Crucifix is shown at the Alte Pinakotek in Munich, West Germany: this is the last stop in a ten-month tour during which the exhibition has been shown in Paris (Louvre Museum), New York (Metropolitan Museum), London (Royal Academy) and Madrid (Prado Museum).